

My Journey in Architecture: Growth, Motivation, and Aspirations

Before entering architecture, I expected that the course would mostly focus on drawing and design. I thought it would mainly be about creativity and visual presentation. However, as I continue my journey, I realized that architecture is not only about drawing but also about thinking, writing, and expressing ideas clearly. In this class, I expect that it will help us improve our writing skills, especially since we will soon work on our thesis. As you mentioned earlier Sir, architects are often more skilled in drawing than in expressing ideas through words.

So far, my experience has been both challenging and motivating. I see myself as someone who is still full of hope. To be honest, I tend to overthink, and sometimes I focus on negative possibilities and pressure myself. However, in a way, this also motivates me to do better. I constantly remind myself that I need to pass all my subjects because I understand how difficult life can be, and I do not want to waste this opportunity due to my negligence.

My current motivation comes from both personal and academic influences. One of the statements that really stayed with me was from our CE professor: "We should claim for uno, but also act as uno." This mindset, together with my belief in manifestation, pushes me to strive harder and stay disciplined in my studies.

I think the architectural topic I find most interesting is designing residential houses, especially by combining different styles such as modern, tropical, industrial, and organic design. Lately, I have been watching vlogs by Oliver Austria, and I was particularly amazed by one of his videos where he explained how he applied passive cooling in his design. I also follow MAD House, which focuses on interior and exterior design, and GIL Bahay Build, where the construction process of a house is clearly explained. Through their content and other online videos, I have become more inspired and interested in architecture.

If I were to explore a topic further, it would be passive cooling. Although it has already been introduced in our tropical design and planning subject, I believe it is highly relevant in our country due to the changing climate. It provides comfort for users while also being energy-efficient. I am particularly inspired by architects who promote Filipino identity in architecture, like Gelo Mañosa, who emphasizes designing spaces that reflect our culture, climate, and lifestyle instead of simply copying Western styles. Growing up in the province near farms, I feel connected to this approach, and it influences how I see architecture today.

Through this journey, I realize that architecture is not only about designing spaces but also about understanding people, culture, and the environment. As I continue this course, I hope to grow not just as a designer, but also as a thinker and communicator, carrying with me my motivations, challenges, and aspirations.

https://youtu.be/FfmmWmW2tEE?si=LDei8NQKMDnHP_Z

<https://youtu.be/bldAELArIUA?si=tbcq-1p1JCSLU670>

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